

Aigo U Watch MP3 UW-F020 512 MB
An MP3 Watch For Geeks

This watch, which looks like an elegant (but not gaudy) analogue watch, has an MP3 player built in. The finish is scratch-resistant galvanised steel-grey and black plastic. We were pleasantly surprised to find that it isn't cheap trash (it's

made in China!)—it's rather stiff and uncomfortable, but once you wear it, it is not that bad. The watch looks rather large. The strap makes it look like an alien contraption, thanks to the embedded USB connector which is to be pulled off to connect it to the PC. The dial is eerie, with hands and hour marks that emit a calm green glow in the dark. Indicator LEDs below the hour marks glow when the MP3 player is turned on, and make the watch look even more surreal.

The device gets instantly recognised as a removable drive, so you can also use it

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Ease of Use	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

System Mechanic 7.5.3
Solid Maintenance For Your PC

One of the first things you'll notice about System Mechanic is the facelift. The new interface has a nice red theme with bits of Vista-like treatment.

Cosmetic details aside, System Mechanic 7 is now in charge of more than just Registry cleaning. It now does everything from checking your system for security holes to maintaining disk drives as well.

ActiveCare is a feature that allows you to select which components System Mechanic should automatically handle. With that set up, you won't need to do anything manually—cleaning up the Registry, for example.

Newcomers won't have to worry with any of the advanced features. System

Mechanic scans your entire system and then lets you decide to fix all the issues it finds. You can also manually run each cleaning task individually. If you do make some massive changes to the Registry during the cleanup, the History feature has you covered—it lets you jump back to previous settings by undoing changes to the Registry.

There's a process manager that displays all running applications—you can choose to shut down applications like you would in the Windows Task

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to carry your data. Transfer speeds are slow—it takes 110 seconds to transfer 100 MB, so it takes around 9 minutes to fill it up. Getting used to the controls is a little frustrating at the start, but you can quickly get the hang of it. The absence of any sort of display is sorely missed, but things are made a little uncomplicated by the LEDs.

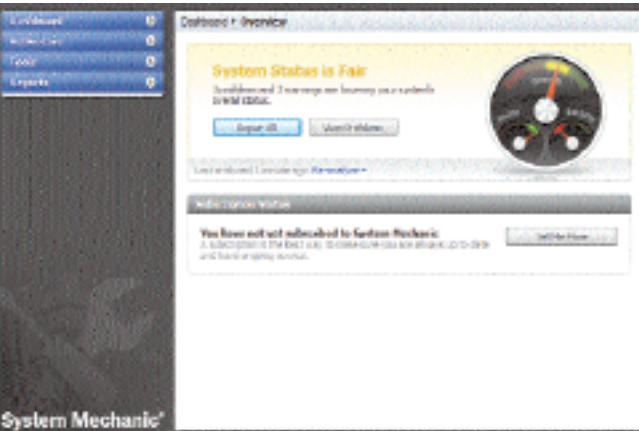
MP3 playback is above par, and the bundled earphones do an excellent job of complementing the player. There are four very effective preset equaliser settings. The fade-in and fade-out effects are there by default, though these often clip a couple of seconds of the start of the first song being played. The earphones are rather large, and may be uncomfortable for some—and thanks to the 2.5 mm jack, you can't connect your favourite headphones, either. It also has a voice recorder with an inbuilt microphone, which made us feel like Johnny Sokko commanding the Giant

Robot—it adds plenty of nerd value.

MP3 playback lasts a little over 5 hours, which is fair—and the watch and player have separate batteries, so you can tell time even after the music stops. 512 MB is just OK for an MP3 player, but may seem less if you have a voracious appetite for audio; there is also a 1 GB version available. Bundled along is a longer cable to connect it to the USB port and software that lets you upgrade its firmware. It costs Rs 4,125—a bit high, since there is no video or even FM Radio.

Specifications
Capacity: 512 MB; Audio: MP3 (32 Kbps - 320 Kbps), WMA (5 Kbps - 256 Kbps); Voice recording: ADPCM; Interface: USB Full Speed 12 Mbps

Contact: Bridge One Technologies
Phone: +91-40-23550794
E-mail: m.barathwaj@gmail.com
Web site: www.aigo.com
Price: Rs 4,125



Manager; only here, you can also stop them from running again. This is useful when you've found what could possibly be a worm or virus on your drive.

The program is fairly light: it only takes up 30 MB of RAM.

System Mechanic 7.5 has come a long way, and there have been a lot of new features added. The price

tag of \$49.95 (Rs 2,000) is still a little too steep, though, considering there are free Registry cleaners like CCleaner available for download.

Specifications
Microsoft Vista / XP / 2000 compatible; Use on up to three PCs

Web site: www.iolo.com
Price: \$49.95 (Rs 2,000)

Brother DCP-135C
Appealing Overall



The DCP-135C is the newest addition to the inkjet digital copier stable of Brother Inc. It is built ruggedly enough to withstand the rigours of office work. It's just 15 cm tall, and the power connector is located to the left, making it easy to place against a wall. This is a four-cartridge inkjet solution—more economical, and the cartridge bay is placed at the front right for easy access.

There is no power button, so you have to use the soft-power switch. The interface is USB 2.0; the USB cable has to be channelled through a narrow canal into the interior of the device—which helps prevent accidental disconnections. The buttons are well-placed, but there can be some confusion—the OK button does not apply a setting unlike most other MFDs (!), so one needs to read the manual. The one-line LCD relays information about status and settings. The input tray holds 100 sheets while the output tray holds 50.

Print quality is decent—there were no smudges, but the borders were not always crisp. Fine print was legible even at the smallest point

size. Colours in the photo print were a little washed out, but not too much—no smudging here either. Normal text printing is slow: 27 seconds for a page, while combination documents print relatively faster at 33 seconds for a page. Printing an A4-size photo takes just under 270 seconds (4.5 minutes)—quite average. The scanner recognised colours accurately, and picked up minute details. It scans really fast—a 300-dpi A4 colour photo took just 49 seconds.

Bundled with the MFD is the ScanSoft PaperPort—a good document management and OCR software. ControlCentre 3 is a control panel that puts all the functions of this MFD at your disposal in a single place. This is an enticing buy at Rs 5,400.

Specifications
Printer: Resolution: 1200 x 6000 dpi (effective); Input tray: 100 sheets, Output tray: 50 sheets; Buffer: 16 MB; Printing technology: 4-cartridge inkjet; Scanner: Flatbed type; Resolution: 600 x 2400 dpi (optical); Media size: A4; Bit depth (output): 24; Dimensions: 39.8 (W) x 36 (D) x 15 (H) cm; Weight: 7.1 kg

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Ease of use	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

Contact: Brother International (India) Pvt Ltd
Phone: 1800-222-422
E-mail: info@brother.in
Web site: www.brother.in
Price: Rs 5,400

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